

Customisation: Building on Top of the ERP

While configuration involves setting up rules and parameters within the ERP system, customisation goes further by building additional functionality on top of the existing ERP platform. Customisation is often necessary when an organisation has unique business processes or requirements not natively supported by the ERP system's out-of-the-box functionality.

Customisation can take various forms, including:

Form Customisation

Creating custom forms or user interfaces to capture specific data or facilitate unique business processes. For example, a healthcare organisation may require custom forms to capture patient information, treatment details, or medical billing data not included in the standard ERP system.

Report Customisation

Developing custom reports to meet specific reporting requirements or data analysis needs. Organisations may need customised reports to comply with industry-specific regulations, generate specialised management reports, or analyse data in a specific format not available in the ERP system's standard reporting capabilities.

Interface/Integration Customisation

Building custom interfaces or integrations to enable seamless data exchange between the ERP system and other applications or systems the organisation uses. This could include integrations with third-party software, legacy systems, or specialised industry-specific applications critical to the organisation's operations.

Workflow Customisation

Involves developing custom workflows to automate and streamline specific business processes, such as approval processes, notifications, or escalation procedures. These workflows can be tailored to reflect the organisation's unique operational requirements, ensuring processes are executed consistently and efficiently.

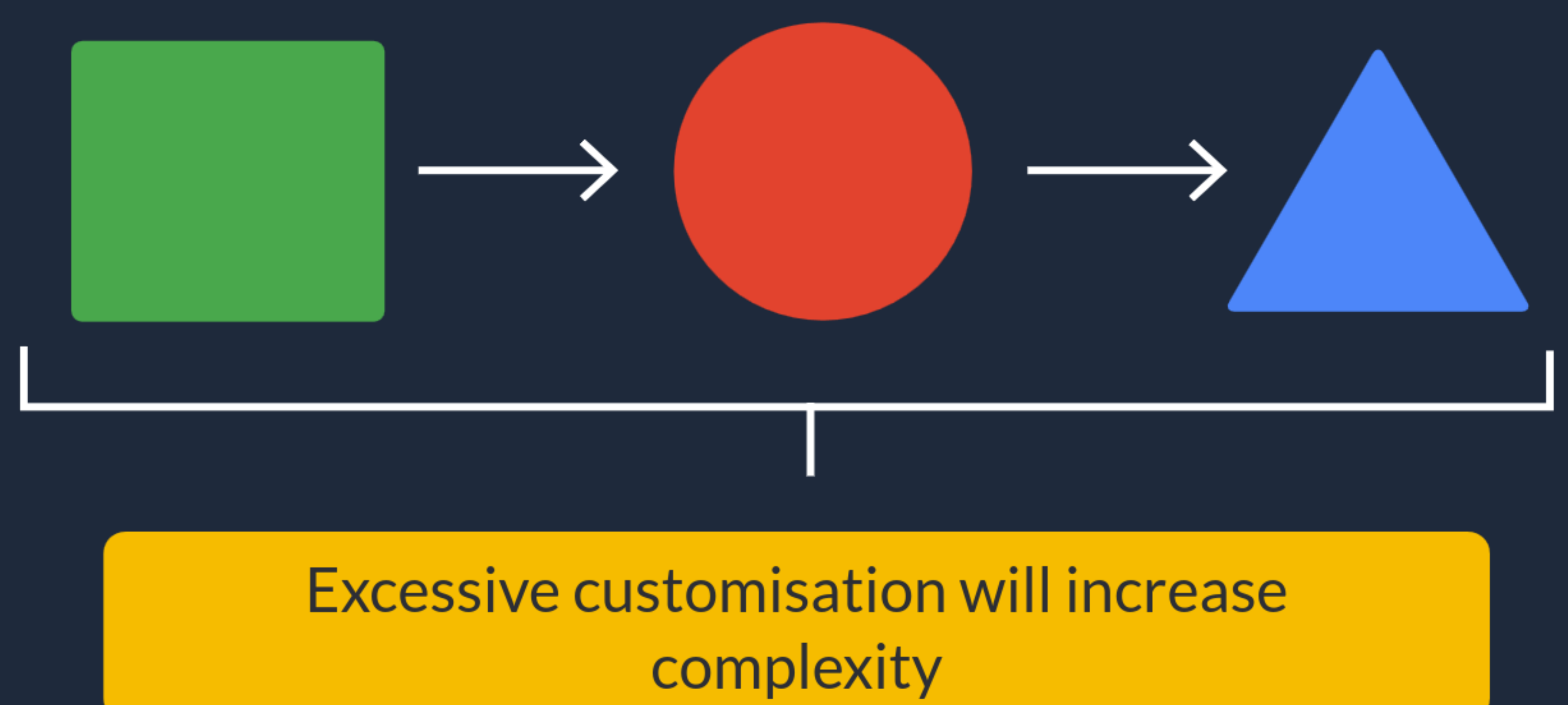
Data Model Customisation

Modifying or extending the ERP system's data model to accommodate specific data types, structures, or relationships not supported by the out-of-the-box data model. This type of customisation is typically more complex and may require significant development efforts.

Business Logic Customisation

Involves implementing custom business rules, calculations, or algorithms within the ERP system to support unique business requirements or industry-specific processes. This could include custom pricing calculations, complex scheduling algorithms, or specialised inventory management logic.

While customisation provides flexibility and allows organisations to tailor the ERP system to their specific needs, it is essential to strike a balance. Excessive customisation can increase complexity, making it harder to upgrade or maintain the system in the future. The ERP vendor may also not support customised components, leaving the organisation responsible for maintenance and support.



Organisations should carefully evaluate the trade-offs between customisation and standardisation, considering long-term costs, maintainability, and the potential impact on future upgrades or system enhancements.